

Gekko gekko

Tokay



Length 7–14 in (18–36 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Mostly arboreal
Status Not evaluated

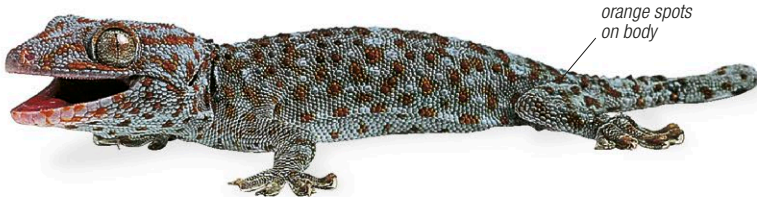
Location S.E. Asia



This gecko is named after the male's loud, explosive call that sounds like "to-kay." It is often found in dwellings, hiding during the day and emerging in the evening to hunt. When threatened by snakes and small, nocturnal mammals, it delivers a hard bite and, if grasped, it discards its tail. The male tokay, which has a larger head than the female, is highly

NIGHT SIGHT

The tokay is a large, blue or grayish blue nocturnal species with large, yellow eyes that enable it to see well in the dark. The vertical pupils close to a slit with 3 "pinholes" in daylight.



TOE PADS



Like most climbing geckos, the tokay has expanded, adhesive toe pads that enable it to gain a firm foothold and move quickly and easily over vertical surfaces such as walls and tree trunks.

territorial and cannibalistic, eating other tokays as well as insects and other small vertebrates. The male mates with several females. The females then attach a pair of spherical, hard-shelled eggs to a vertical surface, often behind bark, or in a crevice or a cavity in a wall.

Gonatodes daudini

Union Island gecko



Length 1½–1¾ in (4–4.5 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Terrestrial
Status Critically endangered

Location Caribbean



Confined to the isolated dry forest of Union Island in the St. Vincent and Grenadines group in the Caribbean, this tiny, red-eyed gecko with enlarged body scales was discovered in rotten wood on Mount Taboi in 2005 at an altitude of 490 ft (150 m). Unlike other tiny members of the genus, this species spends most of its time on the ground. Historically, the species probably had a wider distribution in upland dry forest of the Lesser Antilles—a habitat now cleared through much of this range. Confined to an area of less than 4 square miles (10 square km), the Union Island gecko is now in imminent danger of extinction.

Gonatodes vittatus

Striped day gecko



Length 2¾–3 in (7–7.5 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Terrestrial
Status Least concern

Location N.W. South America



The male striped day gecko is tan, with a black-edged white stripe from the snout to the tail, while the female is gray-brown, with an indistinct white stripe (both are shown below). In both sexes, the eyes lie toward the top of the head. This diurnal gecko lives on the ground among leaf litter, but is also a good climber. It is quick to snap up small insects or spiders. Females often nest together in a communal site, where they lay 2 (rarely single) eggs, each approximately the size of a dried pea.



Hemidactylus frenatus

Common house gecko



Length 4¾–6 in (12–15 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Mostly arboreal
Status Least concern

Location Tropical regions worldwide



This widespread, adaptable, gray or brown gecko mostly inhabits buildings, but may also be found on and under rocks and in tree trunks, often in large

numbers. It can climb smooth, vertical surfaces and cling upside down to ceilings. Rarely seen during the day, the common house gecko hunts for insects, spiders, or smaller geckos that gather near electric lights after dark; it defends its hunting area. When captured, it squeaks and discards its tail readily to escape.



Phelsuma madagascariensis

Madagascar day gecko



Length 9–12 in (22–30 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Arboreal
Status Least concern

Location N. Madagascar



The largest of the green day geckos, this thickset lizard inhabits tree trunks and walls, perching (often head down) on vertical surfaces with the aid of its toe pads. If it successfully evades attack from birds, it can live 10 years or more. Small groups occupy a single tree, and several females may lay eggs in the same site, under bark or in crevices. Males have a swelling at the base of the tail, and reproductive females have calcium deposits that are visible through the skin of their throat.

Ptenopus garrulus

Common barking gecko



Length 2¼–4 in (6–10 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Terrestrial
Status Least concern

Location Southern Africa



A conspicuous feature of many deserts in southern Africa is the sound of the male common barking gecko calling from the mouth of its burrow after dusk. Both sexes have rounded heads, with a blunt snout, and are yellow or grayish yellow, with darker brown or reddish brown spots; their toes are long and strongly fringed with scales. When in danger, this gecko may "freeze," relying on camouflage to avoid detection by predators. Alternatively, it may retreat into its complex burrow system.

Pachydactylus rangei

Web-footed gecko



Length 4¾–5½ in (12–14 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Terrestrial
Status Not evaluated

Location W. southern Africa



This pink gecko is noted for its webbed toes, which enable it to run across desert dunes without sinking into the loose, windblown sand. It spends

the day in long tunnels that it digs in the sand, emerging to forage at night. Due to lack of water in the desert, it drinks the water that condenses on its skin on foggy nights. When threatened, it raises itself on stiffened legs to appear larger.

